

In touch

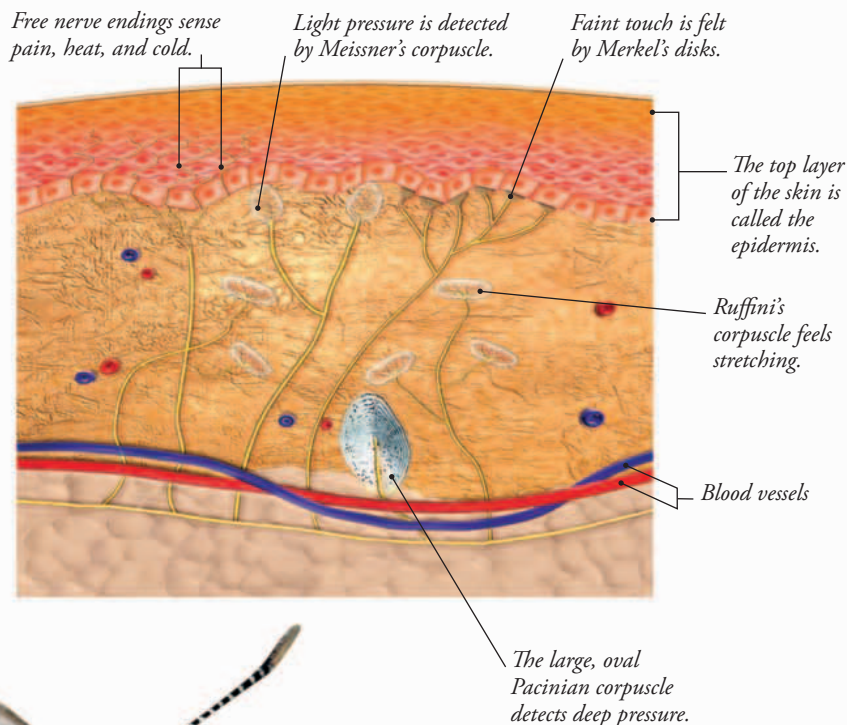
Most of your senses involve individual organs such as your eyes and ears, but your sense of touch works all over your body. The touch sensors in your skin tell you what things feel like and warn you when you might get hurt. Some parts of your body are far more touch sensitive than others.

WOW!

Some people cannot feel pain. This may sound nice, but it actually makes them much more likely to injure themselves.

SKIN SENSORS

Your skin is much more than just a flexible cover for your body. It is packed with touch sensors, which detect sensations ranging from the lightest pressure to the sharpest pain. There are at least six types of sensors. Some are free nerve endings, which detect temperature. Others are tiny disks or capsules (corpuscles), which sense pressure, stretching, and touch.



► LIGHT TOUCH

Small receptors close to the skin's surface pick up the sensation of light touch. Larger receptors deep in the dermis detect pressure.

TYPES OF TOUCH

Why do you need so many different types of touch receptors in your skin? Although they do a similar job, each receptor responds most strongly to a particular type of touch, from feeling the temperature of freezing cold snow, or the faint tickle of a feather, to the pull of skin as it is pinched. Here are five pictures of different types of touch.